

Sasha Zherdeva

(204) 869-6144 | sashardeva@gmail.com | Victoria, BC

Work Experience

Swan Lake Nature Sanctuary

Victoria, BC

Communications Assistant

May 2026 - July 2026

- Developed and produced short-form video content (Instagram/Facebook), doubling average watch time to 7–14 seconds and growing the following by 13%, applying hook testing, pacing adjustments, and Meta Business Suite analytics to refine each video.
- Analyzed post-level performance data through A/B testing to identify what resonated with the sanctuary's audience, lifting shares per Reel from 1–3 to 10-20 by reworking content around those insights.
- Filmed and independently produced a library of 70-100 original clips, building a reusable visual bank for long-term use, applying platform best practices and brand standards.
- Trained the Communications Specialist in DaVinci Resolve and documented a repeatable editing workflow, ensuring content production continued after my departure.
- Launched the sanctuary's YouTube Shorts presence, taking the initiative to open a new distribution platform and reach wider audiences.
- Rebuilt website pages in WordPress and BeaverBuilder to align with brand guidelines, reorganizing the digital asset library for faster retrieval.
- Applied culturally responsive practices to represent Indigenous centred knowledge respectfully across all communications.

University of Victoria

Victoria, BC

Student Content Specialist

September 2025 - April 2026

- Served as a public-facing ambassador across institutional social media platforms (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok), promoting campus programs, events, and initiatives to diverse student and community audiences.
- Developed short-form video content consistently achieving 25,000+ views, applying platform best practices, accessibility standards, and trend analysis.
- Attended and documented campus events, collaborating with event organizers and student groups to capture authentic stories for digital distribution.
- Tracked content deliverables, maintained schedules, and provided regular progress updates to supervisors, ensuring timely submission of drafts and mock-ups for feedback.

Global BC News

Prince Rupert, BC

Stringer (Freelance)

June 2025 - August 2025

- Captured high-quality video footage for broadcast news segments aired across British Columbia.
- Operated camera equipment independently and applied editorial judgment to document local news and events.

Prince Rupert Port Authority

Prince Rupert, BC

Communications Summer Student

May 2025 - August 2025

- Supported public communications and PR initiatives by developing and editing multimedia content (photo, video, blog posts) aligned with organizational objectives and brand standards.
- Created and managed a student-focused blog on SharePoint, crafting engaging captions and stories that resonated with both intern and full-time staff audiences.
- Coordinated with environmental technicians and operations teams to translate technical field work into accessible public storytelling.
- Maintained and updated the core PRPA WordPress website, publishing content, editing pages, and implementing animated slide features, ensuring brand standards were upheld across all digital publications.

BC Parks Foundation

Goldstream Provincial Park, BC

Discover Parks Ambassador

May 2024 - August 2024

- Served as a public ambassador for conservation programs, promoting nature appreciation through social media content and in-person community outreach, including a video reaching 30,000+ views on Instagram.
- Designed and delivered environmental education programs to audiences of up to 80+ participants, informed by data analysis and audience engagement, building strong public communication skills.
- Contributed to seasonal content calendars and storytelling campaigns, developing promotional materials for discoverparks.ca aligned with organizational goals.
- Engaged families, children, newcomers, and seniors in meaningful nature experiences, adapting programming to diverse learning styles and cultural backgrounds.

ICON Creative Studio

Vancouver, British Columbia

Junior 3D Animator

March 2022 – August 2023

- Supported VFX episodic production throughput by delivering an average of 2,000+ frames per 4-weeks while adhering to tight production schedules and evolving priorities.
- Worked within established studio pipelines, utilizing Maya and in-house tools while adapting quickly to new technologies and workflow changes.
- Identified and resolved technical issues in scenes (rig behavior, asset compatibility, file structure).
- Prepared shots for rendering by ensuring clean scene organization, correct file structures, naming conventions, and technical readiness, improving handoff efficiency for teammates.
- Communicated shot status, technical constraints, and feedback with supervisors and directors, ensuring alignment across departments.

Phillip's Lab University of Calgary

Calgary, Alberta

Project Coordinator

March 2022 – May 2022

- Led a multi-disciplinary VFX project, coordinating animation, rigging, and asset workflows while maintaining organized file structures and storage practices.
- Managed shot distribution and task prioritization across team members, ensuring deadlines were met.
- Maintained clean and consistent data organization across project directories, enabling efficient collaboration and minimizing technical issues.
- Verified rigs, props, and scene setups to ensure technical readiness prior to animation and rendering, resolving issues in previously delivered shots.

Bow Valley College

Calgary, Alberta

Teaching Assistant

January 2022 – March 2022

- Supported instructors by troubleshooting technical issues in student scenes, diagnosing errors and clearly communicating solutions to non-technical users.
- Explained complex technical concepts in accessible terms, improving project outcomes and workflow understanding.

Community Involvement**Engineering & Computer Science Students' Society**

Victoria, British Columbia

Director of Professional Development

January 2025 – May 2025

- Planned and promoted campus professional development events (e.g., Discipline Days), coordinating guest speakers, logistics, and student engagement.

- Conducted sponsor outreach for events, confirming participation and securing sponsor attendance to support programming goals.

Kamloops Immigration Services

Kamloops, British Columbia

Photographer / Videographer

March 2024 – June 2024

- Produced photo and video content for community events, highlighting organizational impact and services.
- Engaged with individuals from diverse cultural backgrounds, ensuring inclusive and culturally respectful representation in all content.

Education

University of Victoria

September 2024 – Present

Bachelor of Science in Visual Arts and Computer Science

GPA: 3.7 / 4

Vancouver Film School

January 2021 – January 2022

Diploma in 3D Animation and Visual Effects

GPA: 3.9 / 4

Skills

Communications & Marketing: Social media strategy (Instagram, TikTok, Facebook), copywriting, content calendars, event documentation, community engagement, stakeholder communication, public relations.

Design & Production: Adobe Creative Suite (Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Lightroom), Canva, CapCut, in-platform editing (TikTok, Instagram).

Office & Web: Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, SharePoint), WordPress, CMS/CRM platforms, digital asset management.

Other: Photography & videography (DSLR/mirrorless), public speaking, multicultural audience engagement, environmental education program delivery.